

2483544 - How to avoid ME 038 error (No direct postings can be made to G/L acct. & in CoCode &) ? SAP ERP & SAP S/4HANA

Component: MM-PUR-GF-ACC (Materials Management > Purchasing > Basic Functions > Account assignment),
Version: 15, Released On: 26.03.2026

Symptom

When creating or changing a purchasing document (Contract, Scheduling Agreement, Purchase Order, or Purchase Requisition) via online transactions (e.g., ME21N, ME31K) or BAPI, the system issues error **ME 038**: *"No direct postings can be made to G/L acct. & in CoCode &".*

Environment

- Materials Management (MM)
- Plant Maintenance (PM)
- SAP ERP Central Component
- SAP ERP
- SAP enhancement package for SAP ERP
- SAP enhancement package for SAP ERP, version for SAP HANA
- SAP S/4HANA

Reproducing the Issue

1. Run transaction ME21N
2. Enter required data (e.g. Vendor, Org.Data, Account Assignment Category, Material, Plant)
3. G/L account will be derived automatically but error is raised

Cause

By design, when a purchasing document uses an Account Assignment Category, the system determines a consumption account (Transaction Key **GBB**). Because this G/L account can be manually overwritten or entered by a user, the system treats the transaction as a **manual posting**.

The error occurs because the determined G/L account is flagged for *"Automatic Posting Only"* in its master record.

System Logic: For consumption accounts, the system requires that manual postings be allowed (Field SKB1-XINTB must be empty). If the account is restricted to automatic postings only, the program triggers error **ME 038**.

Note on Process Differences: You may notice different behavior between Purchase Requisitions and Contracts. These processes have different underlying designs regarding account determination processing; therefore, a G/L that works in one may not necessarily be valid for the other if the "Post Automatically" flag is active.

Resolution

Align G/L master data with the Materials Management requirements. Use one of the following options:

1) Adjust G/L Account Master Data

1. Go to transaction **FS02** (or **FAGLo3**).
2. Navigate to the **Control Data** or **Create/bank/interest** tab.
3. Ensure the checkbox *"Post automatically only"* (SKB1-XINTB) is unselected.
4. Ensure there is no **Reconciliation Account** defined for this G/L, unless it matches the logic in Option 2.

2) Align OME9 with Reconciliation Account

If the G/L must remain a reconciliation account (e.g., for Assets):

- 1. Check the reconciliation account type in **FS02** (Field SKB1-MITKZ).
- 2. Go to transaction **OME9** for the used Account Assignment Category (e.g., 'A' or 'Q').
- 3. Ensure the **Consumption Posting** settings in OME9 match the reconciliation account type (e.g., Asset).

3) Enable Value Updating (T134M)

If the error persists despite the above, the special stock indicator (KZBWS) might be empty due to material master settings:

- 1. Go to transaction **SM30** for table **T134M**.
- 2. Locate your **Valuation Area** and **Material Type**.
- 3. Ensure the "*Value updating*" (WERTU) checkbox is ticked. If this is empty, the system disables special stock logic, triggering **ME o38** if the account is set to automatic-only.

Keywords

Lieferplan, Schedule Agreement, Contract, Kontrakt, BANF, Bestellung, Bestellanfrage, Purchase Order, Purchase Requisition, ME51n, ME52n, ME21n, ME22n, ME31l, ME32l, ME31k, ME32k, BAPI_REQUISITION_CREATE, BAPI_PO_CREATE1, BAPI_PO_CHANGE, BAPI_REQUISITION_CHANGE, BAPI_PR_CHANGE, BAPI_PR_CREATE, OME9, FS02, MEo38, ME o38, IP10, IP30, IW31, IW32, IW33, Maintennce Plan, Plant, Maintenance, Order, Maintain Service Details, KZBWS, T134M, WERTU, CHECK_KZBWS, WERTU_ERMITTELN, skb1-mitz, mitkz, manual posting

Attributes

Key	Value
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Outline Purchase Agreements With Vendors > Contract (MM-PUR-OA-CON)
Other Components	Materials Management > Services Management > Account Assignment (MM-SRV-ACC)
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Outline Purchase Agreements With Vendors > BAPIs - Outline Agreements (MM-PUR-OA-BAPI)
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Purchase Requisitions (MM-PUR-REQ)
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Purchase Orders > BAPIs - Purchase order (MM-PUR-PO-BAPI)
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Purchase Requisitions > BAPIs - Purchase requisition (MM-PUR-REQ-BAPI)
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Outline Purchase Agreements With Vendors > Scheduling Agreement (MM-PUR-OA-SCH)
Other Components	Materials Management > Purchasing > Purchase Orders (MM-PUR-PO)
Other Components	Plant Maintenance > Preventive Maintenance > Maintenance Plans (PM-PRM-MP)
Other Components	Plant Maintenance > Maintenance Order Management > Maintenance Orders (PM-WOC-MO)
Requires Action	o

Products

Products
SAP ERP Central Component all versions
SAP ERP all versions
SAP S/4HANA all versions

SAP enhancement package for SAP ERP all versions
SAP enhancement package for SAP ERP, version for SAP HANA all versions

| This document is referenced by

SAP Note/KBA	Component	Title
1900169	MM-PUR-PO- BAPI	<u>BAPI_PO_CREATE1 : Error message ME 038 "No direct postings can be made to G/L acct. & in CoCode &"</u>